AISA · REQUIRED SAFEGUARDING TRAINING

Child Protection, Safeguarding, and Drug Prevention

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. Learn to recognise concerns, respond well, and report them — the welfare of the child is always paramount.

⏱ ~30 min · 📚 12 chapters · ✓ 3 knowledge checks · 🎓 2 PD hours · 🔴 Required annually

📝 Complete the mandatory acknowledgment form

docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdXVYaYcQXupc0LLH7ZR3UE9Ca5k9Xm2AG3Scft8NC65YuWIQ/viewform?usp=header

Safeguarding Committee · reviewed annually

The full annual staff training, as every member of AISA staff takes it on the Learning Hub, with the answer key to its knowledge checks. Required of all staff · 2 PD hours · completion recorded per person on the Hub. Printed 9 November 2026 from aisa-ai-web.github.io/The-Learning-Hub/PD%20Modules/safeguarding-module.html

Contents

1. Why Safeguarding Matters
2. Watch: Safeguarding Briefing
3. Key Definitions
4. Roles & Responsibilities
5. Knowledge Check 1
6. Reporting & Whistleblowing
7. Responding: the 5 R's
8. Knowledge Check 2
9. Types of Abuse & Risk Factors
10. Self-Harm & Suicide
11. Digital Safety, Records & AI
12. Your Team & Counsellors
13. Knowledge Check 3
14. Drug Prevention in Schools
15. Complete Your Training

SECTION 1

Why Safeguarding Matters

AISA is committed to a **safe, inclusive and respectful** environment for every student. Safeguarding is not a single role — it is a shared responsibility held by every member of staff.

⚖️

The guiding principle

The **welfare of the child is paramount**. It is a principle of UAE law and child-protection procedure that the protection and welfare of students must always come first.

📜 The frameworks we follow

Wadeema's Law — UAE Federal Law No. 3 of 2016 (Child Rights)

ADEK safeguarding regulations

ITFCP — Inter-agency framework for child protection

UK **"Keeping Children Safe in Education"** (KCSIE)

🧭 Our guiding principles

- Equal protection for **all** students.
- Students should feel safe **physically, emotionally and digitally**.
- All concerns are taken seriously, acted on promptly, and kept confidential.
- We work in partnership with families, authorities and agencies.

Safeguarding at AISA is reviewed annually by the Governing Board and the Safeguarding Committee.

SECTION 2

Watch: The Safeguarding Briefing

▶ **Safeguarding briefing video** (watched online during the training)

`https://drive.google.com/file/d/1K_5y0lCrTEn54j50MAzrNcsKejj3dbet/view`

Video not loading? Make sure you're signed in with your AISA Google account, then **open it directly in Google Drive**.

As you watch: notice *how* staff are expected to respond to a concern — calmly, without judgement, and by reporting to the DSL. The chapters that follow give you the exact steps.

SECTION 3

Key Definitions

Safeguarding

The **proactive** steps we take to prevent harm before it happens.

Child Protection

The **specific actions** we take when harm is suspected or confirmed.

⚠️ The four types of abuse

- Physical
- Emotional
- Sexual / Exploitation
- Neglect

🧩 ALN — Additional Learning Needs

Support a student may need **beyond typical classroom instruction**. Safeguarding and inclusion work hand in hand.

SECTION 4

Roles & Responsibilities

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Oversees safeguarding, trains staff, and maintains records. **Every concern is reported to the DSL.**

Safeguarding Committee

Counsellor, Nurse, Head of Inclusion, Health & Safety Officer, and Divisional Leaders.

👥 All staff & volunteers — that means you

- ✓ Complete annual safeguarding training.
- ✓ Report concerns**immediately**to the DSL.
- ✓ Follow the Code of Conduct and confidentiality at all times.
- ✓ Avoid private one-to-one interactions with students behind closed doors.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK 1

Your Responsibility

A student tells you something during a lesson that makes you worried about their safety at home. What is your responsibility?

A — Investigate it yourself first, and only involve others if you find evidence.

B — Report the concern to the DSL immediately — safeguarding is everyone's responsibility, and the DSL decides what happens next. ✓ Correct answer

C — Wait to see if the student mentions it again before doing anything.

D — Promise the student you'll keep it completely secret.

Correct. You are often the first responder. Your job is to receive the concern and report it to the DSL promptly — not to investigate it yourself.

SECTION 5 · CRITICAL

Reporting & Whistleblowing

⏱️ The 24-hour rule

Report suspected abuse **within 24 hours**. All reporting goes to the **DSL / Principal** for your division.

🛡️ You are protected

- Whistleblowers are **legally protected** in the UAE.
- To stay anonymous, a reporter must **explicitly request** it.

⚖️ It is a legal duty

Under UAE law, a **mandated reporter who fails to report** is subject to fines and possible legal action. When in doubt, report.

📞 External child-protection contacts

EMERGENCY **999**	MOI CHILD PROTECTION HOTLINE **+971 2 333 3903**
ONLINE **www.moi-cpc.gov.ae**	EMAIL **childprotection@moi.cpc.gov.ae**

🔒 Strict confidentiality

AISA employees are **strictly prohibited** from discussing active or closed cases with any third party — including other employees and the media.

SECTION 6

Responding to a Disclosure — the 5 R's

If a student discloses something to you, follow these five steps.

1 Receive

Listen carefully, **without judgment**.

2 Reassure

Affirm that speaking up was right. **Don't make promises** you can't keep.

3 React

Don't investigate. Ask only **open-ended** questions if you need to.

4 Record

Write the child's **exact words**, date, time and location — right after, not in front of the child.

5 Report

Notify the **DSL** and file the report internally with them.

✅ Do

- Listen empathetically and non-judgmentally.
- Observe the student; let them know they are believed.
- Let them know who they can trust.
- Work closely with the counsellor / admin.

🚫 Don't

- Ask probing or leading questions.
- Try to counsel the student yourself.
- Tell people who don't need to know.
- Assume it isn't true and fail to report.

🤐 On confidentiality with students

Never guarantee absolute confidentiality. It's better to say you *might have to tell someone whose job is to keep them safe*. Don't keep anything illegal, damaging or threatening covered up — and don't engage students who come to complain about other staff; pass it to the DSL.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK 2

Receiving a Disclosure

A student starts to disclose something serious and asks, "Promise you won't tell anyone?" Which response best follows the 5 R's?

A "I'm really glad you told me. I can't promise to keep it secret because I might need to tell someone whose job is to keep you safe — but I'll help you." ✓ **Correct answer**

B "Yes, I promise this stays just between us."

C Ask lots of detailed questions to find out exactly what happened before deciding whether it's worth reporting.

D Tell them you're not the right person and they should speak to a friend instead.

Correct. Reassure without promising secrecy, don't investigate, then record and report to the DSL. Never guarantee absolute confidentiality.

SECTION 7

Types of Abuse & Risk Factors

It is everyone's responsibility to protect students' wellbeing — and at times, **you are the first responder**. Harm can include threats from those responsible for a child's care: **family members, guardians, or other adults** in the student's life.

✋ **Physical**

💔 **Emotional**

🚫 **Sexual / Exploitation**

🥪 **Neglect**

📈 Risk factors to be alert to

- Social isolation
- Neglect
- Trauma — death/illness, divorce or forced separation, witnessing violence
- Loss of protective community mechanisms

🔎 Harm isn't always visible

Adverse Childhood Experiences (ACE) research shows that children from **affluent families** can suffer hidden harm in less visible ways (Felitti et al., 1998). Stay alert across every community, and consider each situation through a thoughtful **cultural lens**.

SECTION 8 · HANDLE WITH CARE

Self-Harm & Suicide

It's okay to not be okay. Your calm, prompt response can save a life.

Self-harm is when someone hurts themselves to cope with very difficult feelings, painful memories or overwhelming situations. It can be a way to make invisible pain visible, to feel in control, or to express suicidal feelings *without* acting on them. Approach it without judgement.

👀 Possible signs of self-harm

- Heavy scratching in one area; unexplained cuts or bruising
- Cuts/scratches to arms, thighs or torso (easily hidden)
- Bruising to knuckles or forehead
- Oddly placed or repeated burn marks
- Multiple plasters/coverings over one area

⚠️ Suicide warning signs

- Talking, writing, texting or drawing about wanting to die
- Planning (notes, researching methods)
- Harming self; expressing hopelessness
- Severe emotional pain or distress
- Marked behaviour changes — withdrawal, sleep changes, anger, agitation

Responding to self-harm

1. Remain calm.
2. Listen with empathy — no judgement, don't question their reasons.
3. Inform the assigned counsellor.

🆘 If you believe a student may be suicidal

1. Maintain **direct physical supervision** of the student.
2. Immediately contact the Safeguarding Lead.

DO NOT WAIT UNTIL CLASS IS OVER OR THE END OF THE DAY.

SECTION 9

Digital Safety, Records & AI

📹 Security & digital safety

- CCTV in all classrooms and main campus areas.
- Visitor ID, sign-in and badge requirements.
- No sharing of student data on personal devices or unapproved platforms.

🗄️ Confidentiality & record keeping

- Secure digital storage, separate from academic files.
- Access only by the DSL and one identified additional safeguarding member.
- Staff must **not** keep personal copies of reports.

🤖 Essential guidelines for AI usage

- ✓ Never input student names, contact details or unique identifiers.
- ✓ Follow data-minimisation principles.
- ✓ Remove identifying details before inputting student work.
- ✓ Use only school-approved, privacy-verified AI platforms.
- ✓ Use pseudonyms (e.g. "Student A") instead of real names.
- ✓ Never share grades, health data or behavioural information.

SECTION 10

Your Safeguarding Team & Counsellors

Elementary Safeguarding Team

Alia Nejdawi — Assistant Principal, **Safeguarding Lead (DSL)**

Counsellors: Laylin Chong · Sara AlBeainy

Nurses: Dinesh Muragan · Kaviya Sasikumar

anejdawi@aisa.sch.ae

Secondary Safeguarding Team

Savvas Largatzis — MS Assistant Principal, **Safeguarding Lead (DSL)**

Counsellors: Naiema Zaki (HS) · Jenn Guss (HS) · Joel Hunter (MS)

Nurses: Jothi Vinod · Kaviya Sasikumar

slargatzis@aisa.sch.ae

👩‍🏫 When to refer a student to a counsellor

- You're concerned about a student's mood, behaviour or emotional needs.
- A parent shares a challenging home/family circumstance.
- Known or suspected medical / mental-health needs.
- A student shares — or you suspect — thoughts of self-harm.
- A student lacks friendships or has poor social skills.
- You'd like support addressing a topic with your class.

Email the counsellor with your referral. Counsellors provide short-term support, crisis response and risk assessments — they do not counsel staff or issue consequences for students. Anything safeguarding-related still goes to the DSL.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK 3

A Student in Crisis

Mid-lesson, a student hands you a note suggesting they are thinking about ending their life. What do you do?

A — Finish the lesson, then email the counsellor at the end of the day.

B — Send the student to the counsellor's office on their own.

C — Keep the student under direct physical supervision and immediately contact the Safeguarding Lead — do not wait. ✓ Correct answer

D — Ask the student in front of the class whether they really mean it.

Correct. Never leave the student alone and never wait. Maintain direct supervision and contact the Safeguarding Lead immediately.

SECTION 11

Drug Prevention in the School Environment

Drug use is a safeguarding and student-welfare issue too. The UAE national guide below, written for school staff, explains the signs to look for, what teachers are expected to do and where students can get help. This page is a quick summary, **not a replacement for the guide.**

📘

Guide to Drugs Prevention at School Environment

UAE Ministry of Interior (SIRAJ national drug prevention programme) in cooperation with the Ministry of Education · First Edition 2021 · English and Arabic · 56 pages · PDF, 4.7 MB

We encourage you to download it and keep a copy to refer to.

⬇ Download the guide

`aisa-ai-web.github.io/The-Learning-Hub/PD%20Modules/assets/Guide-to-Drugs-Prevention-in-School-Environment.pdf`

✅ What to do

- Learn the warning signs: a sudden change of friends, a drop in grades, lying, mood swings, red eyes or dilated pupils, weight loss, constant tiredness, slurred speech, money or valuables going missing.
- Be a positive role model, and make your classroom a place where students feel safe to ask questions and talk.
- Listen without interrupting, and make time to give guidance.
- Build life skills in your lessons: decision-making, resisting peer pressure, coping with stress, choosing good friends. Use interactive methods.
- Look out for students with risk factors, such as falling grades, frequent absence, anxiety or a negative peer group, and ask the counsellor to follow up early.
- Report any suspicion or disclosure straight away to your Safeguarding Lead (DSL) and the counsellor. Treat a student who is using drugs as a student who needs support.

🚫 What not to do

- Don't use fear tactics or scare stories, least of all when a student is telling you what they think or believe about drugs.
- Don't label, shame or stigmatise a student, and don't write them off. Dismissing a student involved with drugs usually makes things worse.
- Don't jump to conclusions. Signs are indicators, not proof, so pass on what you have noticed and let the specialists assess.
- Don't investigate on your own, and don't wait until you are certain. Tell the DSL.
- Don't repeat the myths: cannabis does cause addiction, sedatives are not "safe", a person can become addicted after a first experience, and "I can stop any time" is not true.
- Don't promise a student secrecy.

☎️ Where to get help

Your Safeguarding Lead and the school counsellors (see the previous chapter). Treatment in the UAE is confidential, and the law does not bring a criminal case against a person who asks for treatment voluntarily. The national **Mukafih** service is on **80044**, and the guide lists the treatment centres.

☐ **I have read the Guide to Drugs Prevention at School Environment.**

SECTION 12 · MANDATORY

Complete Your Mandatory Acknowledgment

As a **mandatory requirement**, complete the safeguarding acknowledgment form to confirm you've finished this training. Scan the QR code or use the button below.

📝 Open the acknowledgment form

docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdXVYaYcQXupc0LLH7ZR3UE9Ca5k9Xm2AG3Scft8NC65YuWIQ/viewform?usp=header

> **Remember the essentials: safeguarding is everyone's responsibility · report to the DSL within 24 hours · never promise secrecy · the welfare of the child is paramount.**

Scan to open the acknowledgment form

AISA — American International School in Abu Dhabi

Required Training | Child Protection, Safeguarding, and Drug Prevention · Safeguarding Committee

If a child is in immediate danger, call 999. Report all safeguarding concerns to your DSL within 24 hours.